



Delaware County Commissioners Meeting June 5th 2023

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iyRc6P5ut_w
Publication Date	2023-06-07T00:09:38Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Date: June 5, 2023

Meeting Time: 9:04 AM

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presided over by the Chairman of the Delaware County Commissioners, opening at 9:04 AM with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - Presiding Officer / Chairman: Present
 - Commissioner (Mr. King): Present
 - Commissioner (Ms. Reagan): Present

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Note: Handled out of sequence near the end of the meeting)* Minutes from the previous meeting were approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:16 Board Appointment: Creed Board (Community Revitalization Economic District)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff noted that due to Doug White's retirement from First Merchants Bank, the board lacked a required banking representative. Brad recommended appointing Brian Sapp of First Merchants while retaining Doug White for his familiarity and past work.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) for a one-year term.
- **00:02:19 Board Appointment: East Central Indiana (ECI) Planning District**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board sought to fill an open appointment on the ECI Planning District, noting that Rob Keesling of Brahms had already been attending meetings as a liaison and was interested in serving.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) for a one-year term.
- **00:11:05 Bid Opening: Health Department Renovations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Five bids were opened and read aloud for the health department renovations (including base bids, alternate one for exterior windows, alternate two for emergency generators, and completion times):
 - *Fredericks Inc (Pendleton, IN):* Base bid \$565,000; Alt 1 \$16,140; Alt 2 \$15,714; 120 days.
 - *Atlan Construction (Muncie, IN):* Base bid \$416,100; Alt 1 \$11,500; Alt 2 \$5,700; 122 days.
 - *Pridemar:* Base bid \$388,800; Alt 1 \$16,480; Alt 2 \$11,880; 90 working days.
 - *True Building Victor (Muncie, IN):* Base bid \$452,374; Alt 1 \$1,220.68; Alt 2 \$9,70.46; 63 days substantial, 77 days final.
 - *White Oak Commercial Group (Indianapolis, IN):* Base bid \$596,000; Alt 1 \$33,300; Alt 2 \$29,000; completion days not listed.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and carried to take bids under advisement and refer them to Jamie Bane at the health department for review and recommendation. Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:15:33 Letter of Understanding: State Road 332 Project (INDOT Detour)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Angie
 - **Deliberation Summary:** INDOT notified the county of an upcoming project on State Road 332, closing it for 45 days between 700 West and 800 West from July 5th to August 14th. INDOT requested approval or rejection of the unofficial detour route (County Road 700 West, West Jackson Street, and County Road 821).

Commissioners expressed frustration over receiving short notice and past uncompensated road damage from similar state projects. To protect county infrastructure, officials planned to document pre- and post-closure traffic counts, photograph road conditions, and install additional signage/blockages to deter semi-truck traffic.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
 - **00:21:08 Land Plat Dedication: Lily Platte (Mount Pleasant Township)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Representatives for Lily Platte
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A request to dedicate road rights-of-way on 800 West and 25 South for a 6-lot residential development in Mount Pleasant Township. All planning commission approvals and signatures had been secured.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
 - **00:22:09 Agreement: BIS Digital Courtroom Upgrades**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator / Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The court presented a revised quote from BIS Digital totaling \$16,174.75 (\$3,394.95 per courtroom across all five courts) to hardwire evidence presentation systems rather than relying on unreliable Wi-Fi. Funding will be sourced from American Rescue Plan (ARP) infrastructure funds, saving county general funds.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
 - **00:26:47 Service Agreement: Hugh Smith (Planning Commission)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brandy Ingram & Kylene Swackhammer, Planning Commission
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The planning commission requested a service agreement to retain Hugh Smith who retired last year after over 40 years of service to assist and mentor new principal planner Kylene Swackhammer. The contract will be funded out of the comprehensive plan fund rather than county general funds.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
 - **00:28:47 Ordinance No. 2023-015: Second Reading for Local Public Health Service Fund**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Second reading of an ordinance creating a new fund for local public health services.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
 - **00:29:10 Payment of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review and approval of standard county claims: general claims totaling \$2,266,303.28 and additional claims totaling \$33,955.05.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:29:52 Ricky Yenser** (Newsman and Author): Addressed the board regarding a recent contract signed between the center district and the county wastewater district. He questioned whether utility rates would decrease, recalling a 40% rate increase during the pandemic to rebuild the Westbrook Commax Sewer, and argued that debt should not be funded purely through utility customers without a tax base. He also questioned the expenditure of over half a million dollars on the health department building renovation, calling it an excessive cost, and expressed concern over potential road damage from the upcoming INDOT highway closure.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **00:32:11 Emergency Management Agency (EMA):** Director updated the board that the EMA director, deputy director Cory Kissick, Captain Greg Mike, and Kyle Johnson were awarded a grant and would be attending a hazmat conference in Baltimore from Tuesday through Sunday, with on-call staff remaining available locally.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - **00:33:20** Official motion to recess/adjourn approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
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